

MnDOT's AI Governance Journey & Alignment With Industry Direction

- 2024: Informal AI Workgroup formed, led by Office of Chief Counsel.
- AI Workgroup reports to TDLC, supporting enterprise IT/data strategy and future-state planning.
- Operations Division leadership: Melissa Barnes assigned mobility role to guide AI exploration.
- Developed [MnDOT's Generative AI Standard](#), aligned with [MNIT's TAIGA](#) statewide guidance.
- August 2026: Kickoff of MMB's '[AI the MN Way](#)' workgroup for cross-sector alignment.
- Governance positions MnDOT to meet emerging industry-wide standards and future regulatory frameworks.

Workforce Input, Organizational Readiness & Ethical Guardrails

MnDOT's GenAI Standard & Launch of Microsoft Copilot Training (Summer 2025)

- Responsible use, human verification, strict data-classification rules.
- Provides ethical guardrails addressing privacy, bias, fairness, and transparency.
- Agencywide Copilot training launched to build foundational skills and ensure responsible AI adoption.

Employee AI Survey (Fall 2025)

- Strong interest from employees in AI's potential.
- Need for clear training, hands-on guidance, and gradual adoption.
- Concerns about accuracy, bias, skill deterioration, and over-reliance.

Responsible Implementation: Safety, Procurement, Liability & Next Steps

- AI contract language drafted to ensure contractor alignment with responsible use and data-ownership requirements.
- AI Pilots: Efficiency, safety analytics, information access, and frontline support.
- Safety & Accountability: Human oversight for AI-supported decisions; emerging liability considerations.
- Agencywide AI Vision & Roadmap under development.
- AI Champions to leverage early adopters and meet employees' varied readiness and comfort levels.

Thank You!

Jocelyn Stein

Business Integration & Digital Accessibility Manager

Minnesota Department of Transportation

Jocelyn.Stein@state.mn.us